Designing Reassurance in Digital Payments

A Context-Aware Chatbot for Refund and Payment Clarity

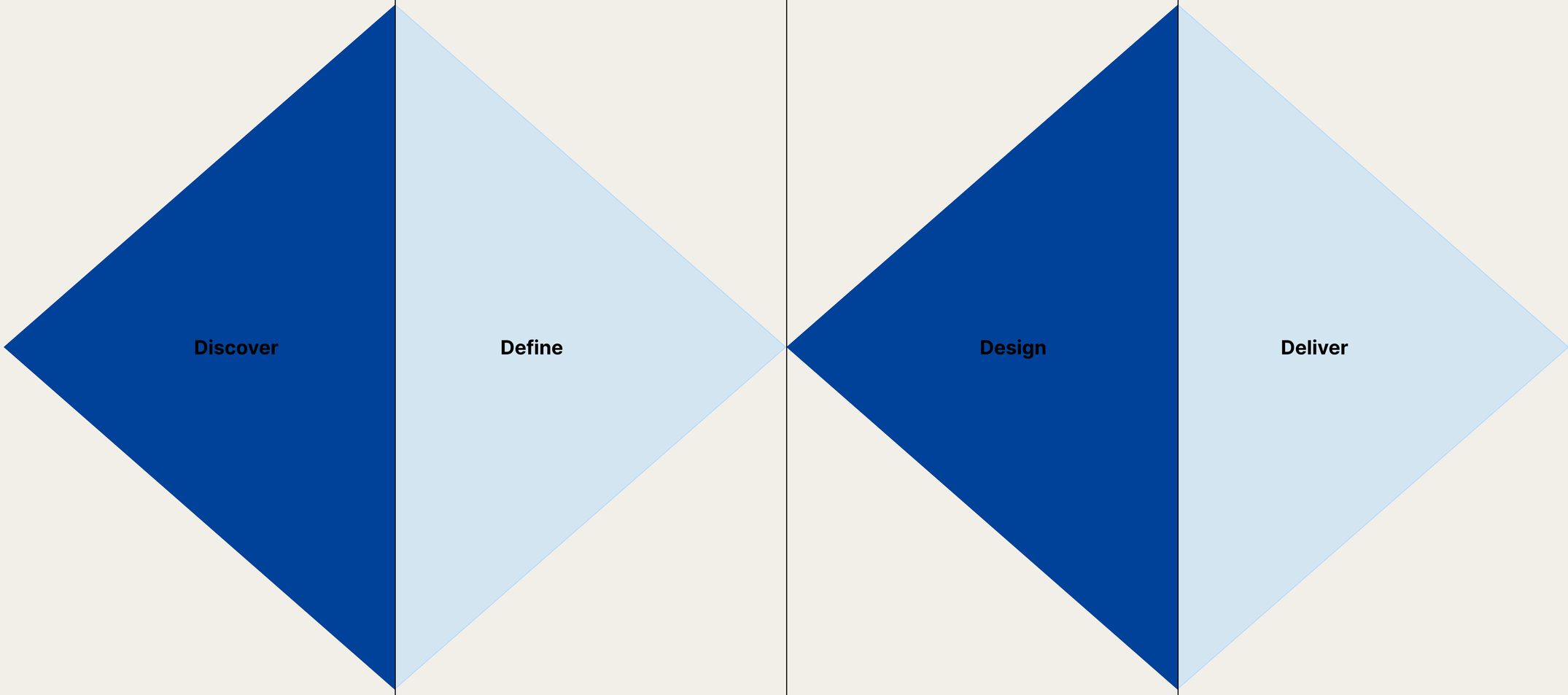


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Double Diamond



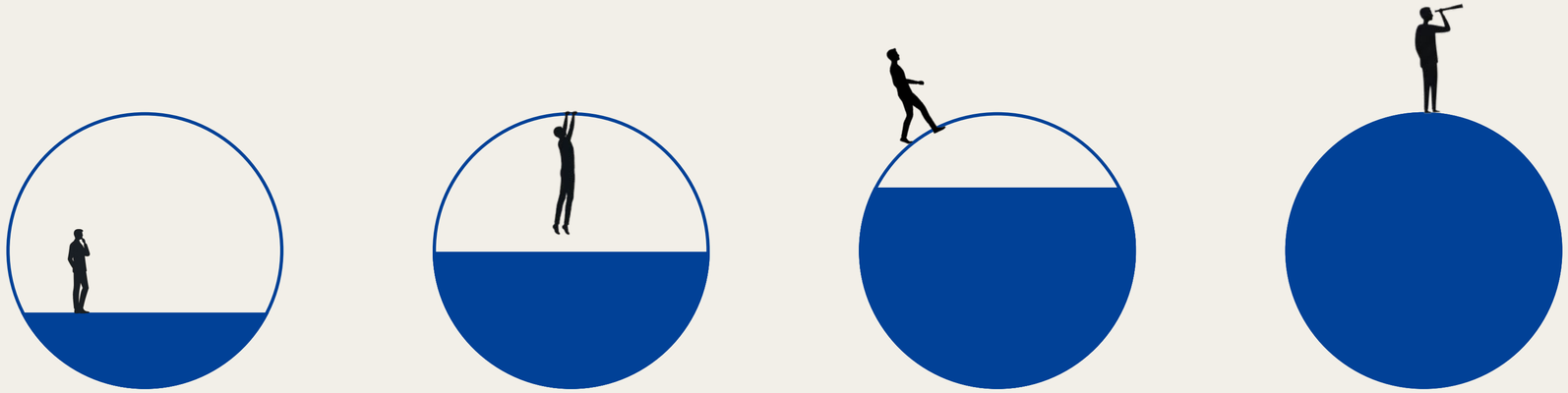
Identified anxiety caused by silent refunds and repetitive chatbot flows

Narrowed the problem to refund confirmation and repetition.

Explored guided, context-aware chatbot interactions.

Built a prototype that reduces anxiety through clarity and system awareness.

Design Process



Empathize

Observed user behaviour during refund and payment issues:

- Anxiety caused by no confirmation after money is credited
- Frustration when chatbot restarts the flow
- Repetition and proof requests breaking trust

(Re)Frame — HMW

How might we reduce user anxiety and repetition when confirming refund status using context-aware technology?
Design principles:

- Simplicity: clear steps instead of conversation
- Emotional reassurance: acknowledging stress around money
- Time-saving: reducing manual checking and repetition

Ideation

Form swap — adapting chatbot behaviour based on user context and system confidence

Prototype

A chatbot prototype is created to validate:

- Refund confirmation
- Payment failure handling
- Context-aware tracking
- Reminder-based reassurance

Project Overview

Problem

Users feel anxious and frustrated because even after a refund is successfully credited, they are not notified. When they contact the chatbot for confirmation, it fails to recognize the completed refund and forces them to repeat the process and provide proof again.

How Might We

How might we use an adaptive chatbot system to reduce user anxiety and repetition when confirming refund status, using context-aware technology?

Scope of the Project

Instead of redesigning the entire customer support system, this project focuses on high-anxiety payment moments where users seek reassurance and clarity.

Design Rules Applied

The solution is guided by the following rules:

- User intent before assumption
- Guide, don’t take control
- Reassurance through presence
- Permission before system intervention
- System confidence determines response

Scenarios Explored

The following scenarios were derived directly from the problem statement:

- **Where is my refund?**
  To help users locate a refund through guided navigation and system confirmation.

- **I got a refund but I can’t see it**
  To address anxiety caused by visibility issues and delayed bank processing.

- **My payment failed / got debited**
  To reassure users when money is temporarily debited and reversals are in progress.

- **Something else**
  To allow users to describe issues outside predefined flows without forcing assumptions.

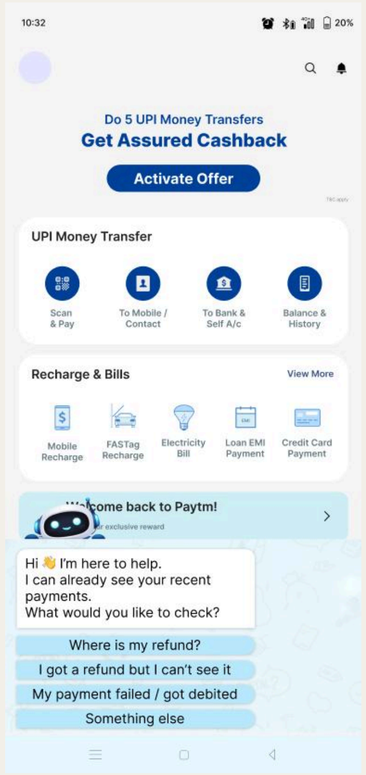
Why These Scenarios

Why These Scenarios
These scenarios represent the most common points where:

- Money is involved
- System feedback is unclear
- User trust breaks due to repetition

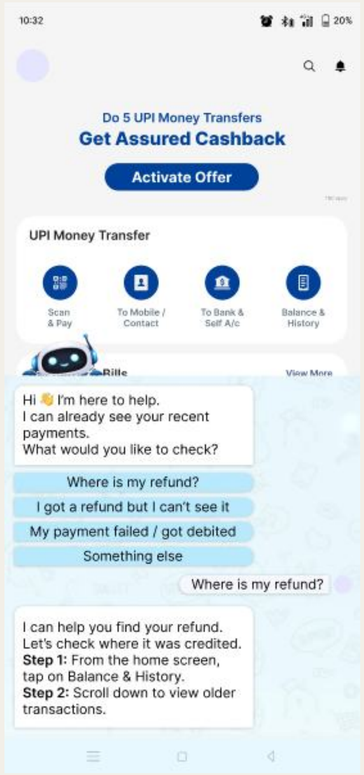
Focusing on these moments allows the chatbot to reduce anxiety with minimal intervention.

Key Screens & Design Decisions



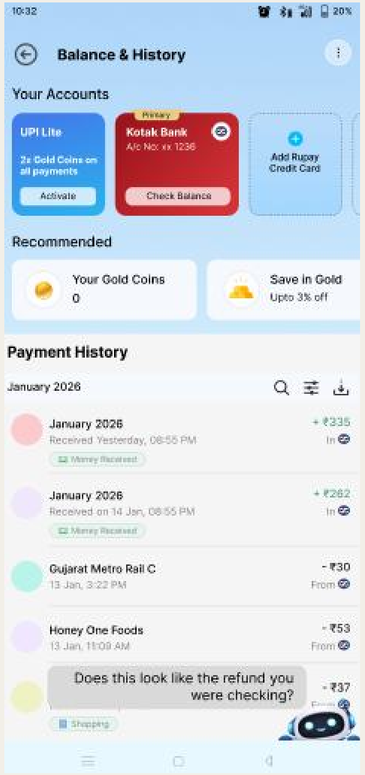
User Intent Before System Assumption

- The chatbot first asks what the user wants to do
- Prevents misdiagnosis and early frustration



Guide, Don't Take Control

- Bot gives step-by-step guidance
- User navigates independently
- Preserves agency during financial actions



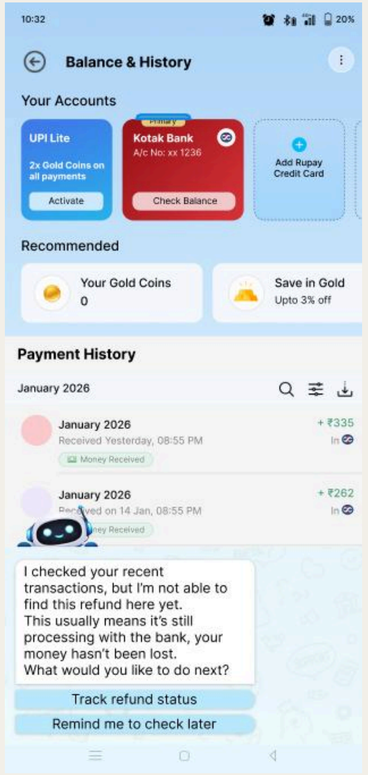
Reassurance Through Presence

- Support is always visible but non-intrusive
- Reduces anxiety without interrupting the task



Permission Before System Intervention

- Explicit consent before highlighting transactions
- Builds trust and transparency



Refund Not Found & Next Steps

- System acknowledges uncertainty
- Offers clear, user-driven options (track / remind)

Prototype Walkthrough

Refund and Payment Scenarios

Scenario 1:Assisted Refund Discovery with User Consent

What problem this flow solves

Users often miss refunds that are already credited and feel anxious when they cannot locate them.

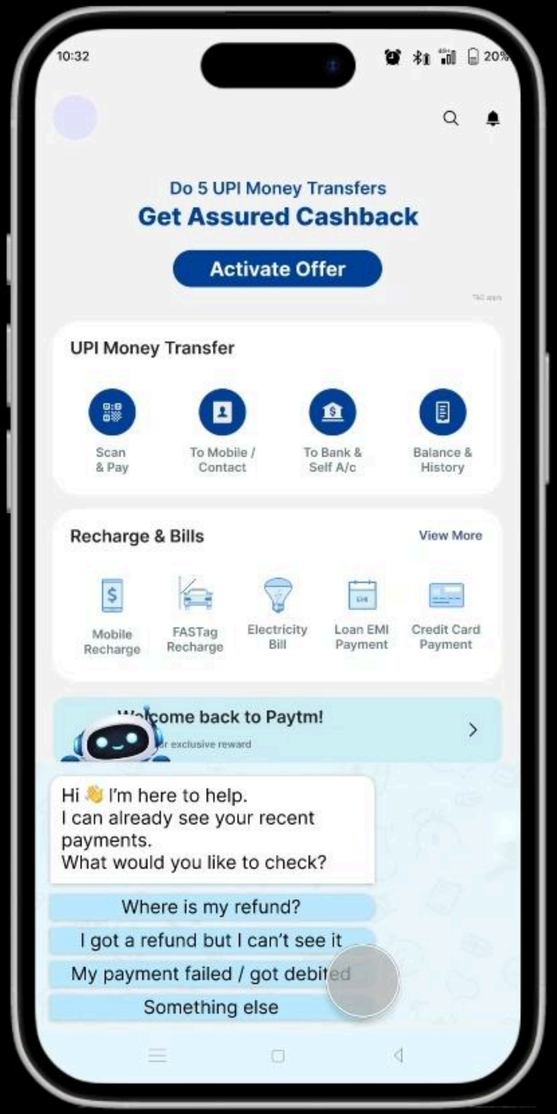
What changed from existing chatbots

Instead of asking users to re-explain or provide proof, the chatbot uses transaction context to guide users to the correct location and asks permission before visually highlighting the refund.

Prototype shows:

Guided navigation → confirmation → consent-based highlighting

Link to the Prototype Video



Scenario 2:Refund Not Found: Follow-Up Support Flow

What problem this flow solves

When neither the user nor the system can confirm a refund, uncertainty increases and trust breaks.

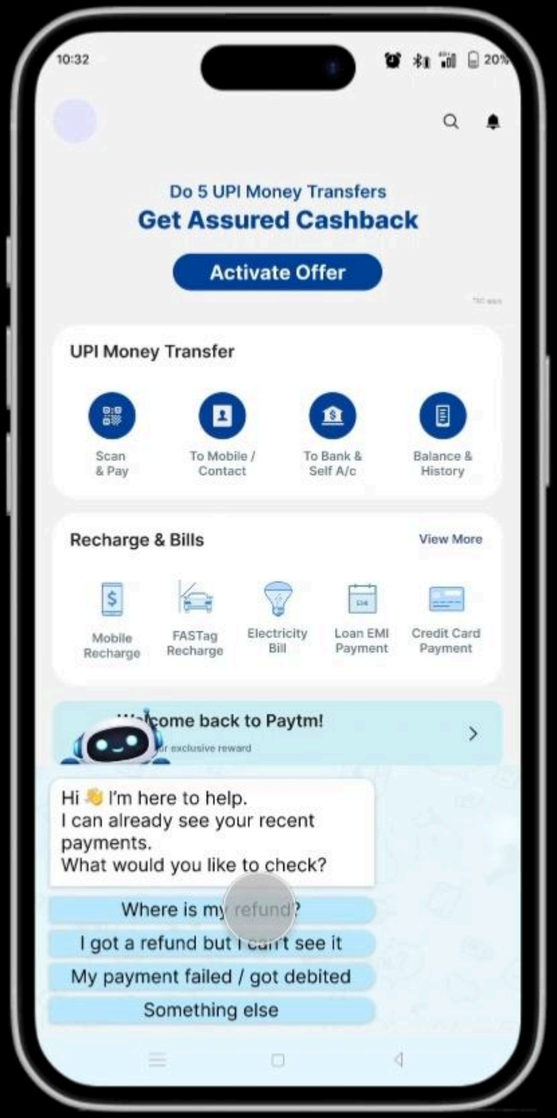
What changed from existing chatbots

Rather than restarting the flow or escalating immediately, the chatbot acknowledges uncertainty and takes responsibility by offering tracking or reminder-based follow-up.

Prototype shows:

System uncertainty → reassurance → reminder / tracking options

Link to the Prototype Video



Scenario 3:Payment Failed but Amount Debited

What problem this flow solves

Users panic when a payment fails but money is debited temporarily.

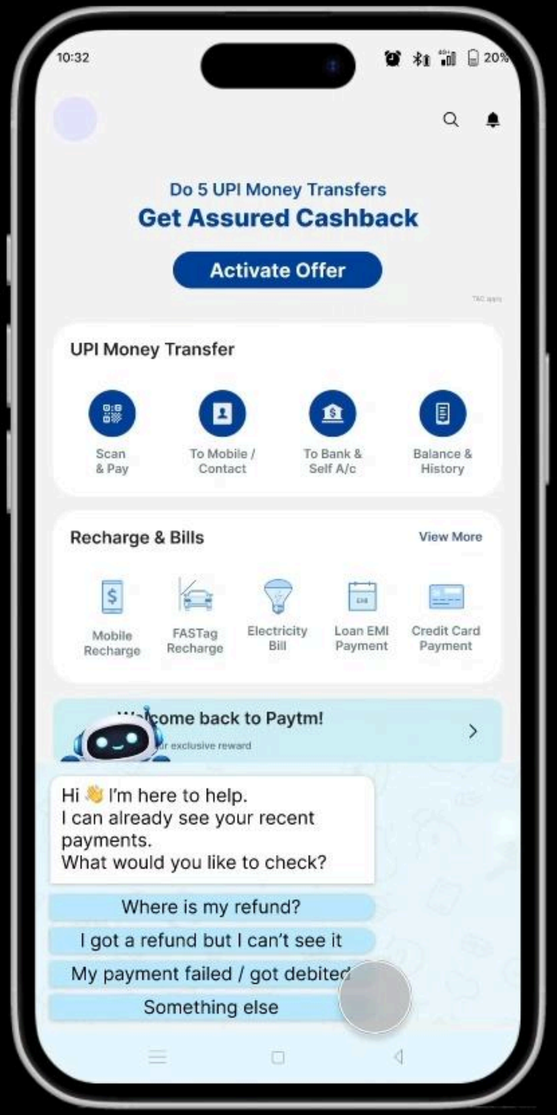
What changed from existing chatbots

The chatbot proactively explains reversal status using system context, instead of asking users to contact the bank or repeat the issue.

Prototype shows:

Debit detection → reversal explanation → progress tracking / reminder

Link to the Prototype Video



Scenario 4:Handling Unlisted Support Requests

What problem this flow solves

Not all user issues fit predefined chatbot options.

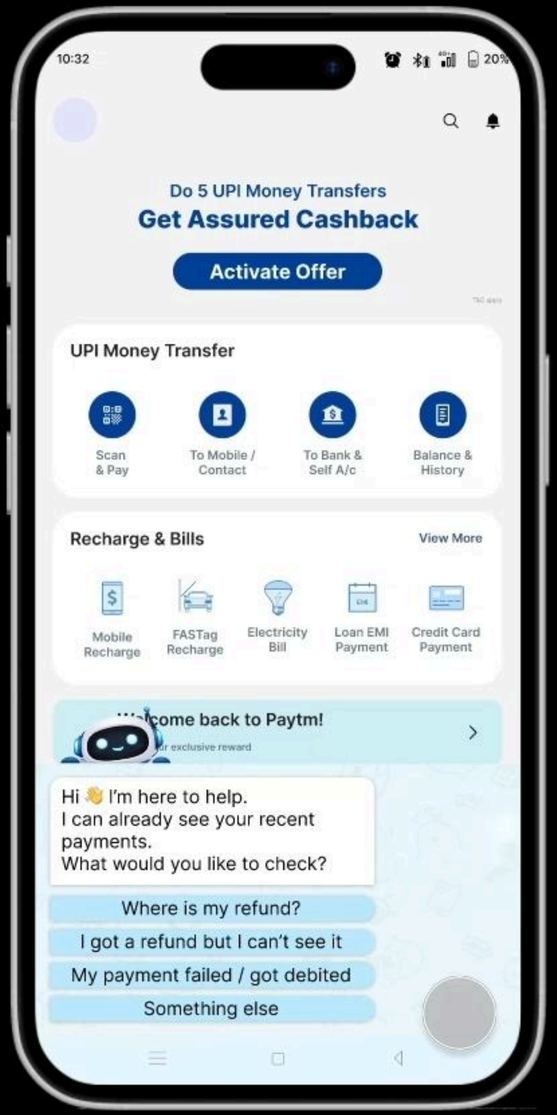
What changed from existing chatbots

Instead of forcing users into incorrect flows, the chatbot opens a search-based input, allowing users to describe their issue without assumptions.

Prototype shows:

Fallback search → flexible support entry

Link to the Prototype Video



Key Takeaway

“Designing support is about reducing uncertainty, not increasing conversation.”